

Q1: Why does a democratic country need a Constitution?

ANS: A democratic country needs a constitution for the following purposes:

- a) It lays down rules that guard against the misuse of power by our political leaders.
- b) The Constitution guarantees the right to equality to the citizens.
- c) Constitution provides certain fundamental rights as well as certain duties to the citizens.

Q2: Look at the wordings of the two documents given below. The first column is from the 1990 Nepal Constitution. The second column is from the more recent Constitution of Nepal.

1990 Constitution of Nepal Part 7: Executive	2015 Constitution of Nepal Part 7: Federal Executive
Article 35: Executive Power: The executive power of the Kingdom of Nepal shall be vested in His Majesty and the Council of Ministers.	Article 75: Executive Power: The executive power of Nepal shall, pursuant to this constitution and law, be vested in the Council of Ministers.

What is the difference in who exercises 'Executive Power' in the above two Constitutions of Nepal?

ANS: According to Constitution of Nepal 1990; the executive power is vested solely in the hands of King. He could exercise his powers as desired. On the other hand according to Interim Constitution of 2007, executive power will be vested in the council of ministers. It means the Parliamentary democracy will function in Nepal. Nepal needs a new constitution which will decide the functions and powers of different heads of government. It will also divide the functions of legislature, executive and judiciary.

Q3: What would happen if there were no restrictions on the power of elected representatives?

ANS: If there were no restrictions on the power of elected representatives then there will be possibility that the elected representatives misuse their power. The misuse of authority and power can lead to gross injustice.

Q4: In each of the following situations, identify the minority. Write one reason why you think it is important to respect the views of the minority in each of these situations.

- a) In a school with 30 teachers, 20 of them are male.
- b) In a city, 5 percent of the population is Buddhists.
- c) In a factory mess for all employees, 80 percent are vegetarians.
- d) In a class of 50 students, 40 belong to more well-off families.

ANS: a) Female teachers are in minority. The views of female teachers should be respected. Female teachers can understand the psychology of children better. Female teachers have to work at home as well as at schools. So, their work-spirit should be considered with respect.

b) Buddhists are in minority. India is a secular country. So, rights of minority religions should be protected. They should be free to practice their own religious practices which encourage peace and non-violence.

c) Non-vegetarian workers are in minority. Factory mess should daily prepare food for 20 % non-vegetarian minority workers. Everybody has the right to eat food according to own choice, this will create better work atmosphere in the factory.

d) 10 % students are poorer and in minority. We must respect their views because they are equal to others. The majority of rich students should behave well with the poor students so that they do not get

inferiority complex. Then there will be better study atmosphere in the class.

Q5: Discuss the following key features of Indian Constitution given below in detail and why do you think these features are important:

a. Federalism. b. Separation of Powers. c. Fundamental Rights. d. Parliamentary Form of Right.

ANS: a). **FEDERALISM**: Federalism means existence of more than one level of government in the country. It helps to manage a country smoothly. Distribution of power makes the progress of a country fast.

b). **SEPARATION OF POWERS**: The separation of powers provide a vital system of checks and balances. It ensures that the different branches control each other. This is intended to make them accountable to each other.

c). **FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS**: The set of Rights which ensure the life of dignity and honour to all who live in its jurisdiction. Fundamental Rights protect citizens against the arbitrary and absolute exercise of power by the state.

d). **PARLIAMENTARY FORM OF GOVERNMENT**: In a parliamentary form of government, people have a direct role in electing their representatives who are accountable to the people. Furthermore, every citizen is free to contest elections irrespective of his or her social or economic status.

Q6: Write down the name of the Indian States, which share borders with the following neighbouring nations:

a) Bangladesh b) Bhutan c) Nepal

ANS: a) West Bengal, Assam, Meghalaya, Mizoram and Tripura share border with Bangladesh.

- b) Arunachal Pradesh, Sikkim, Assam and West Bengal share border with Bhutan.
- c) Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, West Bengal and Sikkim share border with Nepal.

T.P.S.